was broadly shared with the legions of sculptors and the wider public. The scale of these monuments meant that vast resources of Chandela society were marshalled for it, involving many classes of people, whose enthusiasm was essential for success.



Figure 5. Chitragupta Temple panels

If we accept these three premises, we can then ask: What were the shared foundations and pillars of this aesthetic? What was the world view that gave rise to these ‘ecclesiastical erections’, in the memorable words of T.S. Burt?

Sex and the City from Gupta to Chandela Times

Khajuraho’s erotica may jive with modern liberal ideas that celebrate sensual desire and youthful bodies, but the cultural milieu of Khajuraho was quite different from our own. To assess its moral qualities, we ought to understand its social and power relationships and the status it afforded its